

**Recommended Postures for a Professional
Setting
Tone and Tenor
7 C's of Communication**

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Postures for a Formal Setting

Recommended posture

Key points:

- Keep your back straight, in particular:
 - Avoid rounding your shoulders forward with your screen at your eye level)
 - Avoid rounding (or arching) your lower back
- Keep your shoulders relaxed and back
- Place your elbows so that they form an angle of 90-100 degrees (never less)
- Keep your knees at a height of your hips (the thighs should form an angle of 90-100 degrees with the torso)
- Leave your legs relaxed, bent at about 90-100 degrees, leave your feet resting on the ground and do not cross your legs.

Tone & Tenor

Tone & tenor

- Tenor=what you say
- Tone=how you say it
- refer to the overall mood and attitude expressed by a piece of writing
- E.g.: The article had a very somber tone and tenor, befitting the sadness of the event it described.

Example 1

In the spring of the year, in the
spring of the year,
I walked the road beside my dear.
The trees were black where the bark
was wet.

I see them yet, in the spring of the
year.

He broke me a bough of the
blossoming peach
That was out of the way and hard to
reach.

In the fall of the year, in the fall of the
year,
I walked the road beside my dear.
The rooks went up with a raucous
trill.

I hear them still, in the fall of the
year.

He laughed at all I dared to praise,
And broke my heart, in little ways.

Year be springing or year be falling,
The bark will drip and the birds be
calling.

There's much that's fine to see and
hear

In the spring of a year, in the fall of a
year.

'Tis not love's going to hurt my days.
But that it went in little ways.

- [Edna St. Vincent Millay](#)

Example 2

I wandered lonely as a cloud
That floats on high o'er vales and hills,
When all at once I saw a crowd,
A host, of golden daffodils;
Beside the lake, beneath the trees,
Fluttering and dancing in the breeze.

Continuous as the stars that shine
And twinkle on the milky way,
They stretched in never-ending line
Along the margin of a bay:
Ten thousand saw I at a glance,
Tossing their heads in sprightly dance.

The waves beside them danced; but
they
Out-did the sparkling waves in glee:
A poet could not but be happy,
In such a jocund company:
I gazed – and gazed – but little
thought
What wealth the show to me had
brought:

For oft, when on my couch I lie
In vacant or in pensive mood,
They flash upon that inward eye
Which is the bliss of solitude;
And then my heart with pleasure
fills,
And dances with the daffodils.

7 C's of Communication

Principles of Communication or the 7 c's

- Each principle starts with the alphabet C

- I. Completeness
- II. Concreteness
- III. Consideration
- IV. Conciseness
- V. Courtesy
- VI. Clearness/Clarity
- VII. Correctness

Completeness

- ★ Provide all the necessary information.
- ★ Answer all the questions asked.
- ★ Some extra information should also be given, if deemed necessary.

Examples:

1. Please fax me in return the departure from Singapore to Hong Kong on the 8th.
2. How come my request for an interview letter did not receive a response?
3. Show me a portable TV.

Concreteness

- ★ Use specific facts and figures to put action to your words.
- ★ Avoid words like soon, later, few, quickly, at an early date, etc.
- ★ Use active voice and figurative language.
- ★ Use clear, image building words, logical statements instead of emotional statements.
- ★ Pinpoint facts, instead of vague statements.

Examples:

1. Goods will be delivered as soon as possible.
2. Send me the consignment of a few shoes.
3. This book is really good.
4. The tests were administered by the professor.
5. Duties shall be assigned to the secretary.
6. It was decided by the Dean.
7. The company is in great danger.

Consideration

- ★ Adopt the 'you' attitude by giving importance to the customer or the client.
- ★ Emphasize the positive points by avoiding negative messages.

Examples

1. I am delighted to announce that we will be extending shopping hours to make shopping more convenient.
2. We are glad to inform you that we have selected you as the Manager in our firm.
3. You have failed to enclose the cheque in the envelope.
4. Your consignment was not delivered in time because you did not specify the size of the jackets.

Conciseness/Compactness/Precision

- ★ Use the fewest possible words to communicate a complete message.
- ★ Avoid wordy/lengthy expressions.
- ★ Avoid irrelevant material and repetition.

Examples:

1. At this time
2. We are in need of
3. Due to the fact
4. Please find attached the list you requested.
5. She bought desks that are of the executive type.
6. The literature which is enclosed will give you an idea of the appearance of this house.
7. We visited their branch office, which is located in the city of Multan.
8. We have received your order, dated February 23, for which we thank you.

Courtesy

- ★ You should be sincere, thoughtful, and appreciative.
- ★ Show courtesy to your receiver.
- ★ Deal tactfully, show respect, avoid blunt expressions.
- ★ No gender discrimination. Avoid man words like manpower, man made, best man, chairman, where women are also working.
- ★ Know your audience.

Examples:

1. We do not accept spoiled and un-hygienic food. Please take it back.
2. I wrote this letter three times. I don't know why you could not understand.

Clearness or clarity

- ★ Use simple language and familiar words.
- ★ Presence of coherence and unity in paragraphs.
- ★ Think wisely, but communicate in the language of the people.

Examples:

1. Being an excellent lawyer, I am sure you can help us.
2. His report was about managers, broken down by age and gender.
3. After planting 10.000 berry plants, the deer came into the botanist's farm and crushed them.

Correctness

- ★ Use the right language with proper grammar, punctuation, spellings.
- ★ Accuracy of facts and figures must be checked.
- ★ Avoid words that confuse, use simple words instead.

More of the 7 C's

Credibility

- It is not possible to have a reliable communication until and unless the sender is viewed as a credible source for doing business. In short, credibility builds trust.

Consistency

- A consistent thought or approach is very important for the sender. Thoughts are formulated before speaking or sending a message and some start crystallizing while the message is being transmitted.

Jargon & Register

Jargon

- Special words or expressions (vocabulary) used by a profession or group that are difficult for others to understand
- Specific to that field

Register

- Variety of a language used in a particular social setting or for a particular reason
- Formal grammar in a job interview than in a casual setting